

Control of Japanese Thought

govt took action ⇒ promote loyalty to the state and the Emperor ⇒ as well as strong military spirit.

- in addition ⇒ campaign for economic revitalisation ⇒ emphasised traditional values seen in lives of peasants in rural Japan
- contrasted the peaceful, hardworking rural peasant communities within the chaotic and corrupting influence of cities
- Campaign ⇒ also praised women in rural Japan for their traditional roles in working on the farm and managing the home

Govt ⇒ also began to search for strategies ⇒ manage workers and increase productivity

- 1937 ⇒ government implemented a network of discussion councils in all workplaces.
 - made up of worker and manager representatives.
 - they were to cooperate to prevent conflict in the workplaces.
 - workers were told ⇒ that companies were like families ⇒ where every member was equally valuable before emperor

There was censorship of ideas that did not conform with govt beliefs or were seen as threats to Japanese national identity

- Publications monitoring department ⇒ published guidelines for all publishing companies and scrutinised all media ⇒ including fiction books.

1936 ⇒ govt formed information and propaganda committee ⇒ which worked with publications monitoring department ⇒ to further control media and promote their militarist ideas.

- materials that presented military or the Emperor in a bad light were considered inappropriate and censored

Individuals ⇒ who promoted ideas ⇒ that did not conform to the govt ⇒ were silenced

- Individuals with socialist beliefs, such as political leaders, intellectuals and university students ⇒ were imprisoned or dismissed from their positions

Special police force ⇒ set up to enforce this in Japan.

In Japanese empire ⇒ this was carried out by military police, Kempeitai
